

QRU • HEALTH



TEACHER GUIDE

QRU Factory Acceptance Test — Understanding Sleep and Rest — Teacher Guide

Foundational • General public
A Sleep & Rest learning product



**QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding
Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide - Free Preview**

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QRU Teacher Guide - Health

QRU Factory Acceptance Test - Understanding Sleep and Rest - Teacher Guide - Free Preview

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Understanding Sleep and Rest

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Rest Can Pause the Drain, but Sleep Does the Repair

QRU Teacher Guide

Grade Band / Reading Level

Recommended: Grades 7-10

Adaptable for: Grades 6-12 with differentiation

Student reading level target: Grades 7-8

Lesson Duration

Core lesson: 45-60 minutes

Optional extension: One-week sleep-support plan and reflection

Essential Question

Why do humans need sleep, and can rest replace it?

Student-Friendly Big Idea

Sleep is a biologically essential process that helps the brain, immune system, heart, metabolism, emotions, and body recover. Quiet rest, relaxation, and naps can reduce strain and help us feel better, but they do not fully replace enough high-quality nighttime sleep.

QRU Memory Sentence

Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

By the end of the lesson, students will be able to:

1. Explain at least three ways sleep supports the body and brain, including learning, emotions, immune function, heart health, metabolism, or physical recovery.
2. Distinguish between quiet rest, relaxation, naps, and nighttime sleep.
3. Describe why rest can help but cannot fully replace regular, sufficient sleep.
4. Identify at least four habits or conditions that can support or interfere with healthy sleep.
5. Recognize that sleep problems can have medical, mental health, environmental, family, or

schedule-related causes and should not be treated as personal failure.

6. Create one realistic sleep-support strategy that could be used for one week.

Sleep is not simply "doing nothing." It is an active biological process that supports brain function, memory, emotional regulation, immune function, metabolism, cardiovascular health, hormone regulation, and physical recovery.

According to guidance from the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, National Institutes of Health / National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute, and the American Academy of Sleep Medicine, sleep needs vary by age and individual. In general:

- Teens ages 13-18 need about 8-10 hours of sleep per 24 hours.
- Adults generally need 7 or more hours per night.
- Younger children usually need more sleep than teens.
- Individual needs can vary due to development, health, activity level, stress, medications, disability, sleep disorders, family responsibilities, work schedules, and environment.

Sleep is especially important for adolescents because their brains and bodies are still developing. Many teens also experience a natural shift toward feeling sleepy later at night, which can conflict with early school start times.

Credible Source References for Teachers

- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. "How Much Sleep Do I Need?" and "Sleep and Sleep Disorders."

<https://www.cdc.gov/sleep/>

- National Institutes of Health / National Heart, Lung, and Blood Institute. "Sleep Deprivation and Deficiency."

<https://www.nhlbi.nih.gov/health/sleep-deprivation>

- American Academy of Sleep Medicine. "Recommended Amount of Sleep for Pediatric Populations" and sleep health guidance.

<https://aasm.org/>

Sleep habits can support healthier sleep, but they do not solve every sleep problem. Avoid framing sleep challenges as laziness, poor discipline, or student failure.

Sleep problems can involve:

- Medical conditions or sleep disorders
- Anxiety, depression, grief, trauma, or chronic stress
- Pain, medication, disability, or illness

- Family responsibilities or caregiving
- Work schedules or transportation needs
- Noise, light, crowding, safety concerns, or unstable housing
- School start times, homework load, technology access, or community conditions

Recommended Teacher Language

"Healthy sleep habits can help many people, but sleep problems are sometimes medical, emotional, environmental, family-related, or safety-related. If sleep problems are persistent or severe, it is not a personal failure. It is a reason to seek support from a trusted adult, school nurse, counselor, or healthcare professional."

Encourage students to seek support if they experience:

- Trouble falling asleep or staying asleep for several weeks
- Loud snoring, choking, gasping, or pauses in breathing during sleep
- Severe daytime sleepiness or falling asleep unintentionally
- Sleep problems connected to anxiety, depression, trauma, grief, or major stress
- Frequent nightmares, panic, or fear that interferes with sleep
- Sleep loss caused by pain, illness, medication, caregiving, work, housing instability, or safety concerns

Adapt as needed for your district, state, or national framework.

| Standard Area | Lesson Connection |

|---|---|

| Health Concepts | Students learn that sleep supports multiple body systems and is essential for health. |

| Analyzing Influences | Students examine how caffeine, screens, light, stress, exercise, naps, environment, and schedules affect sleep. |

| Accessing Valid Information | Students learn that credible sleep information comes from health organizations and professionals. |

| Decision-Making | Students evaluate sleep-supporting and sleep-disrupting choices. |

| Goal-Setting | Students create a realistic one-week sleep-support strategy. |

| Practicing Health Behaviors | Students choose a practical behavior that may support sleep quality. |

| Advocacy | Students explain why sleep is not wasted time and why rest cannot fully replace it. |

| Term | Student-Friendly Definition |

|---|---|

| Sleep | A natural body and brain state when awareness decreases and the body performs important repair, regulation, and memory processes. |

| Rest | A period of reduced activity or reduced effort. Rest can help the body and mind recover from strain but is not the same as sleep. |

| Relaxation | A calming activity that lowers stress or tension, such as deep breathing, stretching, quiet music, prayer, meditation, or reading. |

| Nap | A short sleep period, usually during the day. Naps can help with alertness but usually do not replace a full night of sleep. |

| Circadian rhythm | The body's internal 24-hour clock that helps regulate sleepiness and alertness. |

| Sleep quality | How well someone sleeps, including how easily they fall asleep, stay asleep, and feel rested afterward. |

| Sleep deprivation | Not getting enough sleep for the body and brain's needs. |

| Sleep debt | The buildup of missed sleep over time. |

| Sleep hygiene | Habits and environmental choices that can support better sleep. |

| Insomnia | Ongoing difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or waking too early, even when there is a chance to sleep. |

| Sleep apnea | A sleep disorder in which breathing repeatedly stops or becomes very shallow during sleep. |

| Caffeine | A stimulant found in coffee, tea, energy drinks, some sodas, chocolate, and some medications that can make it harder to sleep. |

Teacher Materials

- Projector or board
- Timer
- Chart paper or digital slide for class organizer
- Copies of student handouts, or digital access
- Optional: sticky notes or index cards

Student Materials

- Pencil or device
 - Student Handout A: Sleep, Rest, or Relaxation?
 - Student Handout B: Sleep Support Scenario Cards
 - Student Handout C: One-Week Sleep-Support Plan
 - QRU Exit Ticket
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Time	Lesson Segment	Purpose
0-5 min	Opening Quick Write	Activate prior knowledge
5-10 min	QRU Big Idea Mini-Teach	Introduce sleep as biological repair
10-20 min	Direct Instruction + Visual Organizer	Teach sleep functions and sleep needs
20-30 min	Activity 1: Sleep, Rest, or Relaxation?	Clarify key distinctions
30-42 min	Activity 2: Scenario Sort	Apply concepts to realistic situations
42-50 min	QRU Practice/Application	Build a realistic sleep-support strategy
50-57 min	QRU Quick Check	Assess understanding
57-60 min	QRU Reflection / Exit Ticket	Close and reinforce memory sentence

For a 45-minute class, shorten Activity 2 and assign the sleep-support plan as homework.

Before teaching:

1. Review the Teacher Background and Safety Note.
2. Prepare a visual organizer with four columns:
Nighttime Sleep | Nap | Quiet Rest | Relaxation
3. Print or post student handouts.
4. Decide whether students will complete the one-week plan in class or as homework.
5. Prepare private response options for students who may not want to discuss personal sleep challenges publicly.

Part 1: Opening Quick Write

Time: 5 minutes

Display the prompt:

"When someone says, 'I'll just rest instead of sleeping,' what do you think? Is rest the same as sleep? Why or why not?"

Students write silently for 2-3 minutes.

Then invite brief partner sharing.

Teacher Moves

- Accept a range of responses without correcting immediately.
- Listen for misconceptions such as:

- "Rest is basically the same as sleep."
- "Sleep is just for energy."
- "If you are tough, you can train yourself not to need much sleep."
- "Naps always make up for lost sleep."

Transition:

"Today we'll learn why rest can help, but sleep does something deeper. Our QRU memory sentence is: Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair."

Part 2: QRU Big Idea Mini-Teach

Time: 5 minutes

Say:

"Sleep is not wasted time. During sleep, the brain and body are active in important ways. Sleep helps with memory, attention, mood, immune function, growth and repair, heart health, metabolism, and safety. Rest and relaxation matter too, but they are not the same as full sleep."

Display:

QRU Memory Sentence: Rest can pause the drain, but sleep does the repair.

Ask students to repeat or paraphrase the sentence.

Discussion Prompt

- What does "pause the drain" mean?
- What does "does the repair" mean?

Guide students toward:

- Rest can reduce effort and stress.
 - Sleep supports deeper biological processes.
 - Both matter, but they are not interchangeable.
-

Part 3: Direct Instruction + Visual Organizer

Time: 10 minutes

Create or display this organizer.

| Type | What It Is | What It Can Do | What It Cannot Fully Do |

|---|---|---|---|

| Nighttime sleep | Main daily sleep period, usually lasting several hours | Supports memory, learning, emotional regulation, immune function, hormones, heart health, metabolism, and physical recovery | Cannot always be replaced by naps or quiet rest |

| Nap | Short sleep period during the day | Can improve alertness, mood, or performance for some people | May not replace enough nighttime sleep; long or late naps may interfere with nighttime sleep |

| Quiet rest | Reduced activity while awake | Can lower strain, conserve energy, and give the mind/body a break | Does not provide the full brain and body processes of sleep |

| Relaxation | Calming activity that reduces stress or tension | Can help the body prepare for sleep and reduce stress | Is not the same as being asleep |

Teach These Core Points

1. Sleep supports learning and memory.

During sleep, the brain helps organize and store information.

2. Sleep supports emotional regulation.

Insufficient sleep can make emotions feel stronger and harder to manage.

3. Sleep supports immune function.

Sleep helps the body defend itself and recover.

4. Sleep supports heart and metabolic health.

Long-term insufficient sleep is linked with higher risk of hypertension, diabetes, obesity, and cardiovascular disease.

5. Sleep supports safety.

Sleep loss can slow reaction time and increase the risk of injuries, driving accidents, and mistakes.

6. Sleep needs vary.

Teens generally need more sleep than adults. Most teens need about 8-10 hours per 24 hours, while most adults need 7 or more hours.

7. Sleep problems are not always caused by choices.

Medical, mental health, environmental, family, and schedule factors can affect sleep.

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